

Give Bluest a reason to skip the fee math

A monthly out-of-network fee rebate for Bluest checking – the retention lever our premium tier is missing.

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For the September program review · Program owner: M. Castillo

The problem we keep paying for

- ◆ Bluest holders travel, and travelers use whatever machine is in front of them – out-of-network usage on Bluest runs well above the book average.
- ◆ Fee complaints from Bluest customers convert to retention calls at twice the rate of the other tiers; the save offers we improvise cost more than the fees did.
- ◆ Two of the four premium comparators we track reimburse out-of-network fees in some form. Prospects notice; branch staff hear about it.
- ◆ Our own machines cover the metro cores and thin out exactly where Bluest customers spend their weekends.

The ask

Rebate out-of-network fees on Bluest checking, automatically, up to a monthly cap.

\$75

proposed monthly cap – high enough that a Bluest customer never hits it in a normal month

auto

no enrollment, no claim form – the rebate rides the fee, mechanics to be specced with servicing

1 tier

Bluest only – the cap is the tier story, not a bank-wide giveaway

Cap level is the decision we are asking for. Everything else on this page follows the cap.

What \$75 costs (our model)

SCENARIO	AVG REBATE / ACCT / MO	ANNUAL PROGRAM COST	NOTES
Median Bluest user	\$6.40	\$1.34M at current book	Two to three foreign withdrawals a month
90th percentile	\$21.75		Heavy traveler, still far under the cap
Cap-hitters	\$75.00		Modeled at under 0.4% of accounts

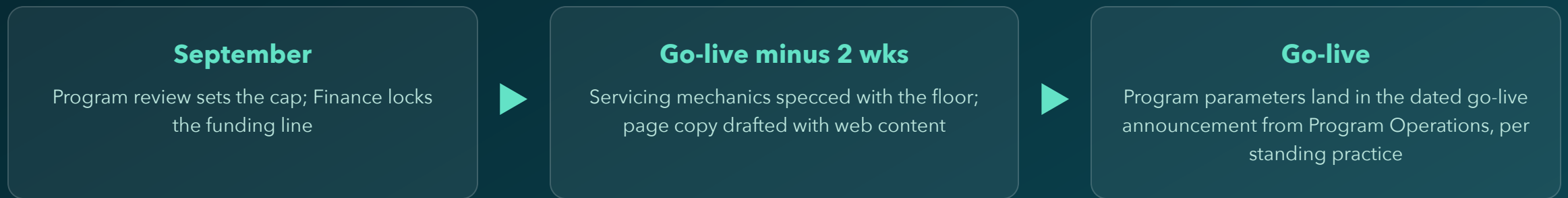
- ◆ Offset: every retention save we don't have to buy back. Save-offer spend on fee complaints ran \$410K annualized in H1.
- ◆ Assumption book and cohort curves are with Finance; T. Brzezinski has the workbook.

Why the big cap is the point

- ◆ A cap nobody hits is a promise, not a coupon. "Your ATM fees come back" is the sentence we want branch staff saying.
- ◆ Smaller caps read as fine print – the comparator programs that underwhelm are the ones with visible ceilings.
- ◆ The cap is also our cost fuse: if usage surprises us, the program's worst case is arithmetic, not an open checkbook.
- ◆ Servicing impact is a wash or better – fee complaints on Bluest become a one-line answer.

Decision and path

We are asking the September program review to set the cap and green-light the build.



Whatever the review decides, the announcement note is the version of record – this deck is the pitch, not the program.